IAEA safeguards; and signing and adhering to an Additional Protocol with respect to civilian nuclear facilities.

At least publicly, the Chinese stuck to their belief that India's fear of alignment with the US and its wish to be an independent great power, as well as the strong opposition inside India against a closer alignment with the United States, would hold India back from 'band-wagoning' with the US. [15] It was only when the 'Agreement for Cooperation Between the Government of the United States of America and the Government of India concerning the Peaceful Uses of Nuclear Energy' (known as the 123 Agreement) became public in August 2007 that China's anxiety reached a level that compelled an escalation in their tactics. It is also believed that it was around this time that China decided to accelerate its nuclear cooperation with Pakistan by 'grandfathering' a deal for new nuclear reactors and also in other matters.

It was after the 123 agreement was concluded and India went to the IAEA while the Americans decided to move the NSG for a clean waiver, that China, having exhausted other tactics, made their unhappiness palpable to the Americans and decided to ratchet up their efforts to disrupt the process in the NSG by several notches. They trained their sights on the membership of the NSG. The Chinese were well aware that within the international community, the general concerns over nuclear proliferation were growing due to the pursuit of nuclear weapons by Kim Jong Il of North Korea, Muammar Gaddafi of Libya and by the religious leadership in Iran. The US-led global nuclear crusade had created an entire community of experts and officials who lived and breathed non-proliferation.

Although the Soviet threat had substantially reduced for Europe in 1991, the characterization of several states as the 'Axis of Evil' by the Bush presidency had dovetailed with the War on Terror to create the ultimate spectre of nuclear